



TEEN KITCHEN (AGES 13-15+) | HIGH-HEAT COOKING, FOOD SAFETY & MEAL COSTING

Ultimate Smash Burgers

Crispy-edged, cheesy double smash burgers with quick homemade sauce and build-your-own toppings. Teen cooks practice safe handling of ground beef, high-heat cooking, temperature testing, timing, and meal assembly.

PREP
10 min

COOK
10 min

TOTAL
20 min

SERVES
4

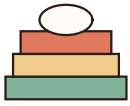


INGREDIENTS

- Burgers: 1 pound ground beef, preferably 80/20
- Burgers: 4 hamburger buns
- Burgers: 4 slices American or cheddar cheese
- Burgers: 1 tablespoon butter
- Burgers: Salt and pepper
- Optional toppings: Shredded lettuce
- Optional toppings: Tomato slices
- Optional toppings: Pickles
- Optional toppings: Thinly sliced onion
- Optional toppings: Ketchup
- Optional toppings: Mustard
- Optional toppings: Burger sauce
- Easy Burger Sauce: 1/4 cup mayonnaise
- Easy Burger Sauce: 2 tablespoons ketchup
- Easy Burger Sauce: 1 tablespoon yellow mustard
- Easy Burger Sauce: 1 tablespoon finely chopped pickles
- Easy Burger Sauce: 1/2 teaspoon pickle juice

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1 Mix the mayonnaise, ketchup, mustard, chopped pickles, and pickle juice. Refrigerate until needed.
- 2 Prepare the toppings before handling raw beef.
- 3 Divide the beef into 8 equal, loosely formed balls. Do not pack them tightly.
- 4 Heat a large skillet or griddle over medium-high heat.
- 5 Working in batches, place 2–3 beef balls on the hot surface and immediately press each into a thin patty with a sturdy metal spatula.
- 6 Season with salt and pepper. Cook for approximately 2 minutes, until the edges are browned and crisp.



- 7 Scrape underneath each patty, flip it, and cook for another 1–2 minutes. Add cheese during the final minute.
- 8 Confirm every patty reaches an internal temperature of 160°F.
- 9 Lightly butter the buns and toast them cut-side down until golden.
- 10 Build each burger with a bottom bun, sauce, lettuce, two patties, pickles, onion, tomato, additional sauce, and the top bun.

LEARNING ACTIVITY

Topic: High-Heat Cooking, Food Safety & Meal Costing

Burger Shop Cost Challenge: Calculate the cost of four double burgers, including buns, beef, cheese, sauce, and toppings. Divide the total by four to find the cost per burger. Compare it with a restaurant burger, then choose a pretend selling price that covers the ingredients and leaves a pretend profit.